

Armored fish

Gemuendina

JEM-yoo-en-DEE-na



- **When** Almost 410 million years ago (Early Devonian)
- **Fossil location** Germany
- **Habitat** Shallow seas
- **Length** 10–12 in (25–30 cm)

A small, flat-bodied fish with a narrow tail, *Gemuendina* looked similar to the modern stingray except that its mouth was on top of its head. Unlike other armored fish, it did not have plates of bone in its mouth. Instead, it used star-shaped scales to grasp prey.

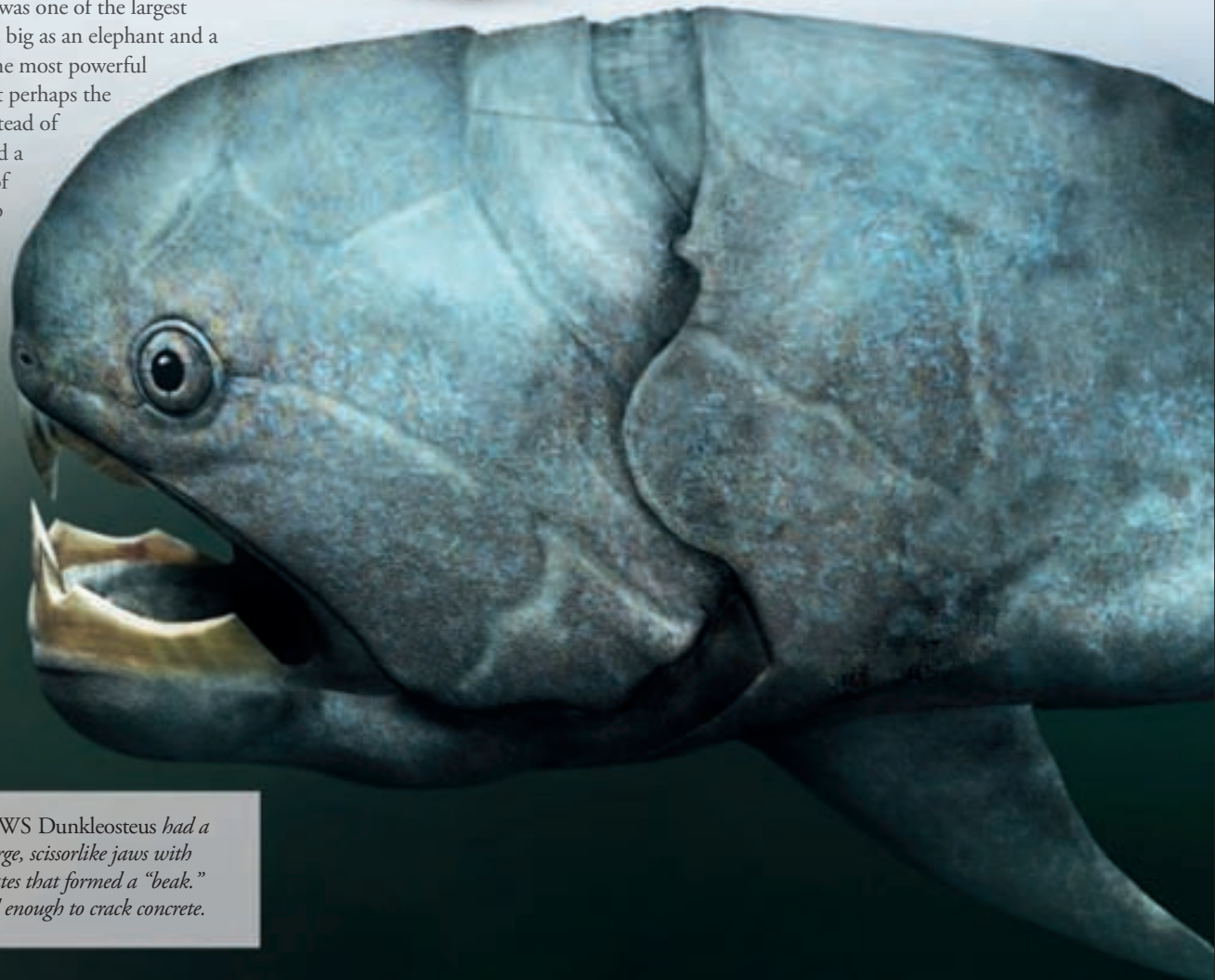
Dunkleosteus

DUN-kell-OSS-tee-us



- **When** Nearly 380 million years ago (Late Devonian)
- **Fossil location** USA, Europe, Morocco
- **Habitat** Shallow seas
- **Length** 20 ft (6 m)

Sometimes described as the *Tyrannosaurus* of the seas, *Dunkleosteus* was one of the largest armored fish. It was as big as an elephant and a vicious hunter, with the most powerful bite of any fish (except perhaps the megatooth shark). Instead of teeth, *Dunkleosteus* had a kind of beak formed of bony plates with sharp points. Some *Dunkleosteus* fossils have bite marks matching these jaws, suggesting the killer was also a cannibal.



▲ **MONSTER JAWS** *Dunkleosteus* had a massive head and large, scissorlike jaws with razor-sharp bony plates that formed a “beak.” Its bite was powerful enough to crack concrete.